

Engaging Russia: On U.S. President Trump, Russia and the Ukraine war

Donald Trump's **overtures** to Vladimir Putin **have spurred** hopes and fears simultaneously

President Donald Trump has **opened the door** to **negotiations** with Russian President Vladimir Putin over ending the war in Ukraine, in equal measure spurring hopes for peace and fears that Moscow would use the opportunity to **manipulate** the situation to its advantage against a **beleaguered** Kyiv. While Mr. Trump wrote on social media that on the 90-minute call both leaders **concurred** on their desire to "stop the millions of deaths **taking place**...", and that Washington and Moscow would "work together, very closely", Russia noted that Mr. Putin had "expressed **readiness** to receive American officials in Russia regarding areas of mutual interest, including, of course, the topic of Ukrainian settlement". Mr. Trump's **call**, including **specifics** on a **ceasefire** and the possibility of their meet in Saudi Arabia, **represents** a break from the **status quo**, which, since Russia **invaded** Ukraine in 2022, has seen the Kremlin face **diplomatic isolation** and **crippling** western/NATO sanctions. Although Mr. Trump's **predecessor**, Joe Biden, **had** in this context made his administration's view on Mr. Putin clear when he described the Russian President as "murderous **dictator**" and a "pure thug", Mr. Trump had promised, even during the campaign leading to the 2024 presidential election, that he would end the war within "24 hours" after being **sworn** into office.

On the one hand, if Mr. Trump's efforts **come to fruition**, it would **mark a breakthrough in terms of** bringing Mr. Putin to the negotiating table, an outcome that has **so far** appeared impossible, **given** Moscow's **resolve** to **press on** with its war plans. On the other, the **terms** of the negotiation **hinted at** so far by the Trump administration make it likely that Ukraine President Volodymyr Zelenskyy will have to accept an **unpalatable** outcome. This appears **inevitable** given that U.S. Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth suggested that no U.S. **troops** would be **committed to** Ukraine in any future security arrangement, that Ukraine would not be invited to join NATO, and that **the option** of Ukraine reverting to pre-2014 borders, prior to Russia **annexing** Crimea, **would be virtually ruled out**. **Indeed**, Mr. Zelenskyy would not be wrong to assume that the U.S.'s promise to **sustain** NATO support for Ukraine "for as long as it takes" has been **unequivocally betrayed** by the Trump administration's **stance** on the subject. This **denouement** is likely to have a **profound** — and damaging — impact on the security and economy of not only Ukraine but also of the EU, given that the White House has **de facto** made Russian **territorial aggression** a European problem, and sees Mr. Putin as a less **concerning** threat than **undocumented migration** and **trade deficits**. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Overture** (noun) – Proposal, Offer, Initiative, Approach, Suggestion प्रस्ताव
2. **Spur** (verb) – Encourage, Stimulate, Prompt, Provoke, Motivate प्रेरित करना
3. **Open the doors** (phrase) – To create opportunities or possibilities. रास्ता खोलना
4. **Negotiation** (noun) – Discussion, Dialogue, Bargaining, Mediation, Talks बातचीत
5. **Manipulate** (verb) – Control, Influence, Exploit, Maneuver, Direct हस्तक्षेप करना
6. **Beleaguered** (adjective) – Troubled, Harassed, Besieged, Stressed, Overwhelmed परेशान
7. **Concur** (on) (verb) – Agree, Consent, Approve, Accord, Harmonize सहमत होना
8. **Take place** (phrase) – To happen or occur. घटित होना
9. **Readiness** (noun) – Willingness, Preparedness, Eagerness, Keeness, Alertness तत्परता
10. **Specifics** (noun) – Details, Particulars, Facts, Information, Elements विशेष विवरण
11. **Ceasefire** (noun) – Truce, Armistice, Peace, Agreement, Settlement युद्धविराम
12. **Status quo** (noun) – Existing condition, Current situation, Present state, Norm, Routine यथास्थिति
13. **Invade** (verb) – Attack, Occupy, Overrun, Conquer, Infiltrate आक्रमण करना
14. **Diplomatic** (adjective) – Tactful, Polite, Strategic, Prudent, Sensitive कूटनीतिक
15. **Isolation** (noun) – Separation, Segregation, Detachment, Loneliness, Solitude अलगाव
16. **Crippling** (adjective) – Devastating, Debilitating, Paralyzing, Harmful, Damaging नुकसानदेह
17. **NATO** (noun) – a military alliance between countries in Europe and North America. It was formed in 1949 to protect member countries from the Soviet Union and the spread of communism
18. **Predecessor** (noun) – Forerunner, Ancestor, Precedent, Antecedent, Former पूर्ववर्ती
19. **Dictator** (noun) – Autocrat, Tyrant, Despot, Oppressor, Authoritarian तानाशाह
20. **Swear** (verb) – Pledge, Vow, Promise, Affirm, Declare शपथ लेना
21. **Come to fruition** (phrase) – To achieve success or realization. सफल होना
22. **Mark** (verb) – Indicate, Signify, Denote, Highlight, Represent संकेत करना
23. **Breakthrough** (noun) – Discovery, Innovation, Advancement, Milestone, Revolution सफलता

24. **In terms of** (phrase) – Regarding or concerning something. के संदर्भ में
25. **So far** (phrase) – Up to this point in time. अब तक
26. **Given** (preposition) – Considering, Taking into account, In view of, Due to, Because of देखते हुए
27. **Resolve** (noun) – Determination, Decision, Commitment, Resolution, Willpower दृढ़ संकल्प
28. **Press** (on) (verb) – Continue, Persist, Proceed, Advance, Move forward जारी रखना
29. **Hint** (at) (verb) – Suggest, Imply, Indicate, Allude, Signal संकेत देना
30. **Unpalatable** (adjective) – Unpleasant, Disagreeable, Distasteful, Unacceptable, Bitter अरुचिकर
31. **Inevitable** (adjective) – Unavoidable, Certain, Inescapable, Predetermined, Sure अपरिहार्य
32. **Troop** (noun) – Soldiers, Forces, Personnel, Army, Unit सैनिक
33. **Commit** (to) (verb) – Pledge, Dedicate, Devote, Promise, Engage प्रतिबद्ध होना
34. **Annex** (verb) – Seize, Occupy, Conquer, Take over, Incorporate हड़पना
35. **Virtually** (adverb) – Almost, Nearly, Practically, Essentially, Effectively लगभग
36. **Rule out** (phrasal verb) – To exclude or eliminate something. खारिज करना
37. **Indeed** (adverb) – Truly, Really, Certainly, Absolutely, Undoubtedly वास्तव में
38. **Sustain** (verb) – Maintain, Support, Uphold, Continue, Preserve बनाए रखना
39. **Unequivocally** (adverb) – Clearly, Definitely, Unambiguously, Absolutely, Firmly स्पष्ट रूप से
40. **Betray** (verb) – Deceive, Mislead, Abandon, Desert, Double-cross धोखा देना
41. **Stance** (noun) – Position, Attitude, Standpoint, Viewpoint, Perspective रुख
42. **Denouement** (noun) – Conclusion, Outcome, Result, End, Resolution नतीजा
43. **Profound** (adjective) – Deep, Intense, Significant, Serious, Far-reaching गहरा
44. **De facto** (noun) – In fact or in reality, even if not officially. वास्तव में
45. **Territorial** (adjective) – Regional, Geographical, Local, National, Spatial क्षेत्रीय
46. **Aggression** (noun) – Hostility, Attack, Violence, Offense, Assault आक्रमण

47. **Concerning** (adjective) – Worrying,
Disturbing, Troubling, Alarming,
Disconcerting चिंताजनक

48. **Undocumented** (adjective) – Unrecorded,
Unregistered, Unofficial, Unauthorized,
Illegal अप्रमाणित

49. **Migration** (noun) – Movement, Relocation,
Displacement, Exodus, Journey प्रवास

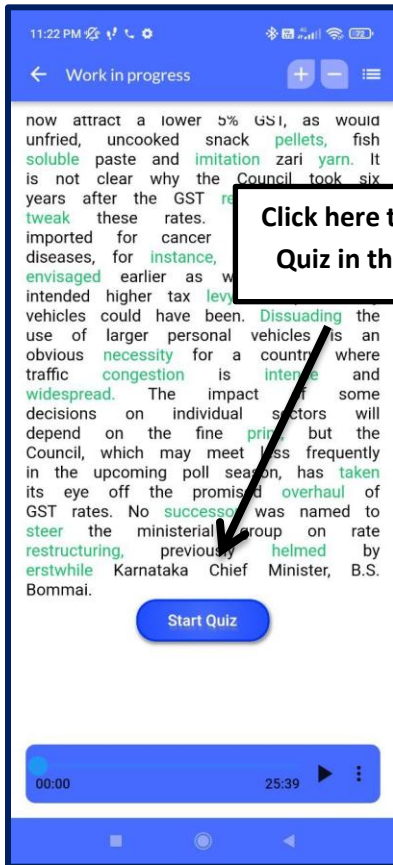
50. **Trade deficit** (noun) – When a country's
imports exceed its exports. व्यापार घाटा

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Summary of the Editorial

1. **Trump's Negotiations with Putin** – U.S. President Donald Trump has initiated talks with Russian President Vladimir Putin on ending the Ukraine war.
2. **Mixed Reactions to the Talks** – While some see this as a step towards peace, others fear it could benefit Russia at Ukraine's expense.
3. **Details of the 90-Minute Call** – Trump and Putin expressed a desire to stop the war and discussed potential U.S.-Russia cooperation.
4. **Russia's Openness to U.S. Diplomacy** – Putin indicated a willingness to host American officials in Russia to discuss Ukraine.
5. **A Shift from the Status Quo** – This move diverges from previous Western policies that have diplomatically isolated Russia since its 2022 invasion of Ukraine.
6. **Contrast with Biden's Stance** – Unlike his predecessor Joe Biden, who condemned Putin as a "murderous dictator," Trump has taken a more conciliatory approach.
7. **Trump's Campaign Promise** – He had pledged to end the Ukraine war within 24 hours of assuming office.
8. **Potential Breakthrough in Negotiations** – If successful, Trump's efforts could mark the first real step towards diplomacy with Moscow.
9. **A Likely Unfavorable Deal for Ukraine** – Ukraine's President Zelenskyy may have to accept compromises that favor Russia.
10. **U.S. Withdrawal from Military Support** – Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth stated that no U.S. troops would be committed to Ukraine's defense.
11. **No NATO Membership for Ukraine** – The Trump administration appears unwilling to allow Ukraine to join NATO.
12. **Pre-2014 Borders Not an Option** – A return to Ukraine's pre-Crimea-annexation borders is unlikely under Trump's proposed terms.
13. **A Betrayal of Previous U.S. Commitments** – Ukraine may view this shift as a reversal of past U.S. assurances of long-term NATO support.
14. **Implications for European Security** – The EU may face heightened security risks as the U.S. shifts its focus away from countering Russian aggression.
15. **Trump's Broader Priorities** – His administration appears to prioritize issues like undocumented migration and trade over countering Russia.

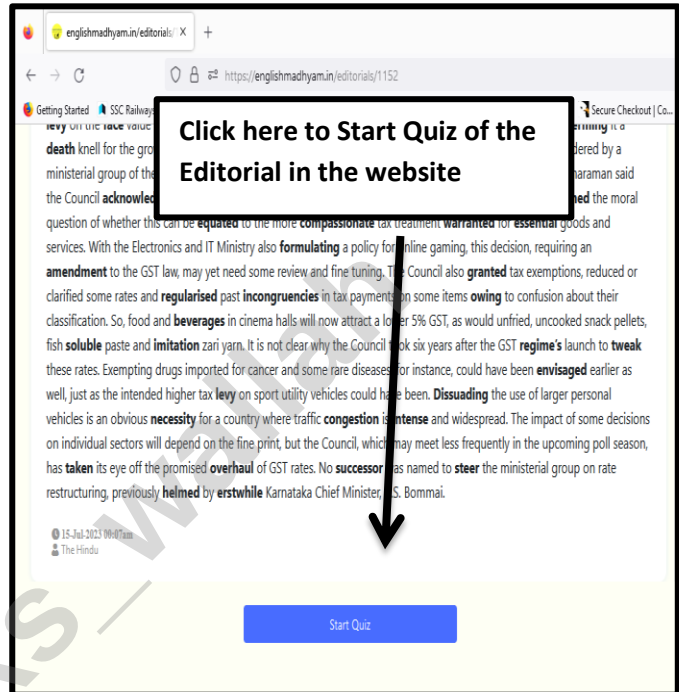
Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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